Lesson 35 material: Late Adulthood: Discussion, Listening and Reading

English Stage 2 (B2) · Unit 3: Verb Tenses and Narration · The Human Lifespan

10.1: Discussion

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Answer the following questions based on your experience and opinion. Read five classmates' posts and respond to two classmates pointing out any similarities or differences, asking clarifying questions, or giving your opinion on a point they make.

1. How old is the oldest person you know?
2. What factors do you believe contribute to living a longer life?

10.2: Listening-Population Pyramids- Powerful Predictors of the Future

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

3.3.2.1. Exercise 1-Listening Comprehension

Watch the video Population Pyramids: Powerful Predictors of the Future and build a basic understanding to prepare you for this chapter's reading. Answer the questions to check your comprehension.

1. According to the Population Reference Bureau's "2013 World Population Data Sheet", 271 are born every minute, and 106 die every minute. That's a global net population increase of 165 per minute. This lesson was published on May 5th. What's the estimated global population increase exactly one week later (May 12th).

a. Approximately 10 million
b. 20,739
c. 1,155
d. 1,663,200

2. Factors that can alter the trend represented by a population pyramid include:

a. industrialization
b. natural disasters
c. education of women
d. all of the above

3. As a country slows in population growth, its pyramid shape will

a. become wider at the base and narrower at the top
b. be inverted
c. become more rectangular
d. bulge in the middle

4. What does a Population Pyramid not give you information about?

a. birth rates
b. actual number of people
c. life expectancy
d. death rates

5. Which continent would have the fastest growth pyramids?

a. Africa
b. Asia
c. North America
d. South America

6. In an advanced stage of industrialization, a country will exhibit which set of characteristics?

a. Low birth and death rates, stable population, good living conditions, long life expectancy.
b. High birth and death rates, stable population, poor living condition, short life expectancy.
c. High birth rate and low death rate, growing population, good living conditions, long life expectancy.
d. High birth and death rates, stable population, harsh living conditions, short life expectancy.

"Population Pyramids: Powerful Predictors of the Future" by Kim Preshoff is licensed by TED under CC BY-NC-ND 4.0

Links on the original page

- Population Pyramids: Powerful Predictors of the Future: https://ed.ted.com/lessons/population-pyramids-powerful-predictors-of-the-future-kim-preshoff

10.3: Reading-Introduction to Physical Development in Late Adulthood

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

3.3.3.1. Exercise 2-Reading Comprehension

Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

3.3.3.1.1. "Graying" of America

The term "graying of America" refers to the fact that the American population is steadily becoming more dominated by older people. In other words, the median age of Americans is going up.

According to the U.S. Census Bureau's 2017 National Population Projections, the year 2030 marks an important demographic turning point in U.S. history. By 2030, all baby boomers **will be older** than age 65. This **will expand** the size of the older population so that 1 in every 5 residents **will be** retirement age. And by 2035, it's projected that there **will be** 76.7 million people under the age of 18 but 78 million people above the age of 65.

(Picture: Image 28 2030 marks an important demographic change as international migration is expected to overtake natural increase in the United States.)

Image 28 2030 marks an important demographic change as international migration is expected to overtake natural increase in the United States.

The 2030s are projected to be a transformative decade for the U.S. population. The population is expected to grow at a slower pace, age considerably and become more racially and ethnically diverse. Net international migration is projected to overtake natural increase in 2030 as the primary driver of population growth in the United States, another demographic first for the United States.

Although births are projected to be nearly four times larger than the level of net international migration in coming decades, a rising number of deaths will increasingly offset how much births are able to contribute to population growth. Between 2020 and 2050, the number of deaths is projected to rise substantially as the population ages and a significant share of the population, the baby boomers, age into older adulthood. As a result, the population **will naturally grow** very slowly, leaving net international migration to overtake natural increase as the leading cause of population growth, even as projected levels of migration remain relatively constant.

3.3.3.1.2. "Graying" Around the World

While the world's oldest countries are mostly in Europe today, some Asian and Latin American countries are quickly catching up. The percentage of the population aged 65 and over in 2015 ranged from a high of 26.6 percent for Japan to a low of around 1 percent for Qatar and United Arab Emirates. Of the world's 25 oldest countries, 22 are in Europe, with Germany and Italy leading the ranks of European countries for many years (He, Goodkind, and Kowal, 2015).

By 2050, Slovenia and Bulgaria are projected to be the oldest European countries. Japan, however, is currently the oldest nation in the world and is projected to retain this position through at least 2050. With the rapid aging taking place in Asia, the countries of South Korea, Hong Kong, and Taiwan are projected to join Japan at the top of the list of oldest countries and areas by 2050, when more than one-third of these Asian countries' total populations are projected to be aged 65 and over.

Reading-The Graying Population" is derived from "Introduction to Physical Development in Late Adulthood" by Sonja Ann Miller licensed under CC BY.

1. "Graying of America" refers to American's hair turning gray earlier than in other countries.

a. True

b. False

2. What is not a projected change in the 2030s in America?

a. The older population will increase significantly.

b. More people will immigrate to the US than are born in the US.

c. The population will grow quicker.

d. The race and ethnicity of the population will become more diverse.

3. Which statement explains the pace of population growth in America?

a. The births will be much higher, but deaths will also be higher.
b. The population is getting older, and people aren't having as many children.
c. Many people are emigrating from the United States

4. Where is the majority of the "oldest countries" today?

a. Asia
b. Latin America
c. Europe
d. The Middle East

16.8: Chapter 8

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4.8.1. Listening Comprehension

00:07 Russia, with the largest territory in the world,

00:10 has roughly the same total population as Nigeria,

00:13 a country 1/16 its size.

00:16 But this similarity won't last long.

00:18 One of the populations is rapidly growing,

00:21 while the other is slowly declining.

00:23 What can this tell us about the two countries?

00:25 Population statistics are some of the most important data

00:29 social scientists and policy experts have to work with.

00:33 But understanding a country's situation

00:35 and making accurate predictions

00:37 requires knowing not just the total size of the population

00:40 but its internal characteristics,

00:42 such as age and gender distribution.

00:45 So, how can we keep track of all that data

00:47 in a way that makes it easy to comprehend?

00:49 Complex data is more easily interpreted

00:51 through visualization,

00:53 and one of the ways that demographers represent

00:55 the internal distribution of a population

00:57 is the population pyramid.

01:00 Here, the data is divided by gender

01:02 with females on one side and males on the other.

01:05 The population numbers are shown

01:07 for each five-year age interval,

01:09 starting from 0-4

01:10 and continuing up to 100 and up.

01:12 These intervals are grouped together

01:14 into pre-reproductive (0-14),

01:17 reproductive (15-44),

01:20 and post-reproductive years (45 and up).

01:23 Such a population pyramid can be a powerful predictor

01:26 of future population trends.

01:28 For example,

01:29 Rwanda's population pyramid shows it to be a fast-growing country,

01:33 with most of the population
01:34 being in the youngest age groups at the bottom of the pyramid.
01:37 The number will grow rapidly in the coming years.
01:39 As today's children reach their reproductive years
01:42 and have children of their own,
01:44 the total population is almost certain to double
01:47 within the next few decades.
01:48 For our second example,
01:50 let's look at Canada,
01:51 where most of the population is clustered
01:53 around the middle of the graph.
01:55 Because there are less people
01:56 in the pre-reproductive age groups
01:58 than there are in the reproductive ones,
02:00 the population will grow more slowly,
02:03 as the number of people reaching their reproductive years decreases.
02:06 Finally, let's look at Japan.
02:09 Because the majority of its population
02:11 is in its post-reproductive years
02:13 and the number of people is smaller
02:15 at each younger interval,
02:16 this means that at current rates of reproduction
02:18 the population will begin to decline
02:20 as fewer and fewer people reach reproductive age.
02:24 Comparing these three population pyramids
02:26 side by side
02:27 shows us three different stages
02:29 in a demographic transition,
02:30 as a country moves from a pre-industrial society
02:33 to one with an industrial
02:34 or post-industrial economy.
02:36 Countries that have only recently begun
02:38 the process of industrialization
02:40 typically see an increase in life expectancy
02:42 and a fall in child mortality rates
02:45 as a result of improvements
02:46 in medicine, sanitation, and food supply.
02:49 While birth rates remain constant,
02:51 leading to a population boom.
02:53 Developing countries that are farther along
02:55 in the industrialization process

02:57 begin to see a fall in birth rates,

02:59 due to factors such as

03:00 increased education and opportunities for women outside of child-rearing

03:04 and a move from rural to urban living

03:07 that makes having large families

03:09 less economically advantageous.

03:11 Finally, countries in advanced stages of industrialization

03:14 reach a point

03:15 where both birth and death rates are low,

03:18 and the population remains stable

03:20 or even begins to decline.

03:21 Now, let's take a look at the projected population pyramids

03:24 for the same three countries in 2050.

03:27 What do these tell us

03:29 about the expected changes

03:30 in each country's population,

03:32 and what kinds of factors

03:33 can alter the shape of these future pyramids?

03:36 A population pyramid can be useful

03:38 not only as a predictor of a country's future

03:40 but as a record of its past.

03:42 Russia's population pyramid

03:44 still bears the scars of World War II,

03:47 which explains both the fewer numbers of elderly men

03:50 compared to elderly women

03:52 and the relatively sudden population increase

03:54 as soldiers returned from the war

03:56 and normal life resumed.

03:58 China's population pyramid

03:59 reflects the establishment of the one child policy

04:02 35 years before,

04:04 which prevented a population boom

04:06 such as that of Rwanda

04:07 but also led to sex-selective abortions,

04:10 resulting in more male children than female children.

04:13 Finally, the pyramid for the United States

04:16 shows the baby boom that followed World War II.

04:19 As you can see,

04:20 population pyramids tell us far more

04:22 about a country

04:23 than just a set of numbers,

04:25 by showing both where it's been

04:26 and where it's headed

04:28 within a single image.

04:29 And in today's increasingly interconnected world,

04:31 facing issues such as food shortages,

04:33 ecological threats, and economic disparities,

04:36 it is increasingly important

04:38 for both scientists and policy makers

04:40 to have a rich and complex understanding

04:43 of populations and the factors affecting them

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